



» FIFA WORLD CUP
PERSPECTIVE

Destiny beyond borders

The biggest story of the 2026 World Cup was not just goals and glory, but how immigrants helped **redefine** international football.

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Last month, the United States of America (USA) once again debated birthright citizenship. The Supreme Court weighed in, President Donald Trump had his say, and one of the country's defining realities came into focus: the USA is, and has long been, a nation shaped by immigrants.

'Give me your tired, your poor; Your huddled masses yearning to breathe free...' begins the

famous excerpt from American poet Emma Lazarus' sonnet inscribed at the base of the Statue of Liberty.

It was, therefore, fitting that the FIFA World Cup 2026, co-hosted by the USA, Mexico and Canada, became a celebration of football's own immigrant story. From France's Kylian Mbappe, born to Cameroonian and Algerian parents, to Spain's Lamine Yamal, whose father is Moroccan and mother Equatorial Guinean, some of the tournament's brightest stars served as a reminder of how migration has